

Crispy Chicken Thighs with Roasted Garlic Pan Sauce (Variation 18)

Tags: chicken, dinner, low-carb, gluten-free, quick | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 35 min | Serves: 4

Ingredients

- 8 bone-in, skin-on chicken thighs
- 1.5 tsp fine salt
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 whole head of garlic, cloves separated but unpeeled
- 4 sprigs fresh thyme
- 250 ml chicken stock
- 1 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 2 tbsp cold unsalted butter, cubed
- fresh cilantro to serve

Method

1. Pat chicken thighs completely dry. Mix salt, pepper, garlic powder, and paprika. Season thighs all over.
2. Heat oil in a large oven-safe skillet over medium-high heat.
3. Place chicken thighs skin-side down. Do not move them. Cook for 12–15 minutes until skin is deeply golden and crisp.
4. Flip thighs and add garlic cloves and thyme to the pan.
5. Transfer pan to a 200 °C oven. Roast for 15 minutes until chicken is cooked through (75 °C internal).
6. Remove chicken from pan and rest on a rack.
7. Squeeze roasted garlic from skins into the pan. Discard thyme.
8. Place pan over medium heat. Add stock and scrape up all browned bits. Whisk in Dijon.
9. Simmer for 3 minutes until slightly reduced. Swirl in cold butter until sauce is glossy.
10. Spoon sauce over chicken and serve with parsley.

Chef Tips

- Starting skin-side down in a cold pan allows fat to render slowly, yielding crispier skin.
- Do not move the chicken during the first 12 minutes — it will release naturally when ready to flip.
- The cold butter swirled in at the end is classic French 'monter au beurre' — creates a glossy emulsified sauce.